St. Joseph's Anglo-Chinese School
F.6 English Language
Grammar – Lesson 5 (Enhancing Accuracy)
Teacher's notes · 60 minutes · Lesson 2 of 3 before the mock

TEACHER'S NOTES — keys and corrections in red. Not for students.

Level 2: Simple sentences are well formed.

Level 3: Simple sentences, and some complex sentences are well formed.

Level 4: A range of sentence structures is used accurately and appropriately; errors do not affect overall clarity.

PART 1: LESSON AT A GLANCE

Time	Stage	Teacher	Students
0–3	Frame	Say: 'Nothing today is marked. You write, practise, then fix your own paragraph.'	Pens out.
3–18	Cold write	Silent, 15 min, no notes. Hold the clock.	Write article introduction, approx. 75 words. Level 3: star one complex sentence.
18–26	Error types	Board: the four codes. Walk three sentences through them.	Copy codes onto error card.
26–34	Practice sentences	6 sentences. Two already correct.	Fix errors. Self-mark.
34–42	8-error hunt	8 min. Collect totals for chart.	Find 8 errors. Count: caught ___ / 8.
42–48	Own-text hunt	5 min. Circle only.	Apply codes to own paragraph.
48–53	Fix	Enforce ten-word rule. Peer-check.	Fix in second colour.
53–56	Transfer write	3 min. 'His advice for stressed students', approx. 40 words.	New paragraph.
56–60	Peer proofread	4 min. Swap, apply codes, sign.	Mark codes on partner's page.

PART 2: WRITE NOW (15 MINUTES)

Frame it: 'This paragraph is not marked. You will fix it yourself in forty minutes.'

The task:

You have interviewed a past student who left a well-paid job as a doctor to follow a lifelong dream. Write an article about this past student for the school magazine.
Write an introduction to the article (approx. 75 words).
15 minutes, silent, pens only. No notes, no dictionaries, no talking.
Level 3 group: also include ONE complex sentence and put a star beside it.

Do not correct anything while they write. Their real errors are the raw material.

PART 3: THE MOST COMMON TYPES OF ERRORS

The four codes (same as Lesson 4):

Code	What it covers	Example
S	Sentence boundary: no verb, no subject, two sentences joined by a comma, a fragment	Her work as a nurse was tiring, she never complained.
V	Verb: ending, tense, missing 'be', subject-verb agreement	No one understand why he left medicine.
W	Word form: right word, wrong form	I was very surprising to hear the news.
N	Noun and article	It was a honour to meet such a brave person.

The examples are different, but the questions are the same. Ask the two questions every time.

PART 4: PRACTICE SENTENCES (8 MINUTES)

Six sentences. Two already correct. The errors are DIFFERENT sub-types from Lesson 4, but the codes are the same. This trains transfer, not memorisation.

1. I was very surprising to hear the news.
2. No one understand why he left medicine.
3. He posted his first video in January, it went viral within a week.
4. His advice has changed my daily habits.
5. It was a honour to meet such a brave person.
6. Dr Lai records a new video every Sunday.

No.	As printed	Error	Corrected sentence	Code
1	I was very surprising to hear the news.	Word form	I was very surprised to hear the news.	W
2	No one understand why he left medicine.	Subject-verb agreement	No one understands why he left medicine.	V
3	He posted his first video in January, it went viral within a week.	Comma splice	He posted his first video in January. It went viral within a week.	S
4	His advice has changed my daily habits.	Correct	No change.	—
5	It was a honour to meet such a brave person.	Article before vowel sound	It was an honour to meet such a brave person.	N
6	Dr Lai records a new video every Sunday.	Correct	No change.	—

Sentences 3 and 5 are the ones students typically miss: sentence 3 is a comma splice that looks like two short correct sentences; sentence 5 involves the article before a vowel sound. Sentences 2 and 7 show subject-verb agreement in different contexts ('No one' and 'His advice').

PART 5: THE 8-ERROR HUNT (8 MINUTES)

Project or photocopy. The errors are the same families the practice sentences trained, but placed inside a longer, more complex text.

Have you ever wondered what makes someone walk away from a guaranteed future, Dr Jason Lai, our 2015 graduate, did exactly that

After six years in medical school and three years at Queen Mary Hospital

He was earn a six-figure salary every month, however, he felt unfulfilling

He quit his job in 2023, he started a YouTube channel called Wellness Daily

He upload videos about mental health and sleep habits to help stressed students

His advice are practical and easy to follow

Last month he reached one million subscribers

It is a inspiration for anyone afraid to follow their passion.

No.	As printed	The error	Correction	Code
1	… guaranteed future, Dr Jason Lai …	Comma splice — rhetorical question + statement fused by a comma	Have you ever wondered what makes someone walk away from a guaranteed future? Dr Jason Lai, our 2015 graduate, did exactly that.	S
2	After six years in medical school and three years at Queen Mary Hospital.	Fragment — prepositional phrases with no subject or finite verb	After six years in medical school and three years at Queen Mary Hospital, he was earning a six-figure salary every month.	S
3	He was earn a six-figure salary	Wrong verb form (past continuous mis-formed)	He was earning a six-figure salary every month.	V
4	he felt unfulfilling	Word form	however, he felt unfulfilled.	W
5	He quit his job in 2023, he started …	Comma splice	He quit his job in 2023. He started a YouTube channel called Wellness Daily.	S
6	He upload videos	Subject-verb agreement	He uploads videos about mental health and sleep habits to help stressed students.	V
7	His advice are practical	Subject-verb agreement (uncountable noun)	His advice is practical and easy to follow.	V
8	It is a inspiration	Article before a vowel sound	It is an inspiration for anyone afraid to follow their passion.	N

COMPOSITION: 3 S / 3 V / 1 W / 1 N. Note that sentences 3 and 4 contain two errors in one sentence (was earn + unfulfilling) — this is common in student scripts and should be named aloud.

CONTENT / ORGANISATION / LANGUAGE REMINDERS

Use these in class to show students that the plant text is a model answer WITH errors, not errors in a weak answer. The ideas and organisation are worth studying even while hunting the grammar.

Sentence 1 (Hook):

Content: opens with a direct question to the reader ('Have you ever wondered…'), immediately engaging the audience. Names the person and the dramatic decision. Organisation: classic magazine hook — question first, answer second. Language: the comma splice is the only error; the rhetorical device itself is exactly what school-magazine articles need for reader awareness.

Teaching note: Teach students that a hook is not just 'interesting' — it must point directly to the article subject. This one does both: it asks about career change, then names Jason Lai in the same breath.

Sentence 2 (Background):

Content: establishes credentials (medical school, Queen Mary Hospital) — specific places students recognise. Organisation: background comes AFTER the hook, not before. The reader is already curious, so the detail lands. Language: the fragment is the subtlest error. Students see 'medical school' and 'Queen Mary Hospital' and assume it is a complete sentence because the vocabulary is sophisticated.

Teaching note: This is different from Lesson 4's participial fragment. Here the fragment is purely prepositional ('After six years…'). Students who only hunt for 'missing verbs' in obvious places will miss it.

Sentence 3 (Contrast):

Content: the tension — high pay (six-figure salary) versus emotional cost (unfulfilled). Organisation: creates the 'why' before the 'what'. Specific number (six-figure) makes it real. Language: two errors in one sentence — verb form (was earn) and word form (unfulfilling).

Teaching note: Note that 'unfulfilling' describes the JOB, but the writer meant the PERSON felt unfulfilled. This is the same error family as Lesson 4 (exciting/excited) but in a different semantic field, which helps transfer.

Sentences 4–5 (The Switch):

Content: three concrete actions (quit, started, uploads) with naming (Wellness Daily, mental health, sleep habits). Organisation: moves from problem to solution; naming the channel makes the career switch tangible. Language: comma splice + subject-verb agreement. The shift from past tense (quit, started) to present (uploads) is exactly what students struggle with when writing articles.

Teaching note: The channel name 'Wellness Daily' is capitalised as a proper noun — a small but important register point. The problems addressed (mental health, sleep habits) are chosen because the reader is a student. This is reader awareness in action.

Sentences 6–7 (Impact + Closing):

Content: quantified success (one million subscribers) and universal meaning (inspiration, follow their passion). Organisation: closes with evidence (subscribers) then a takeaway (inspiration). Language: advice are (uncountable noun + plural verb) and a inspiration (article before vowel).

Teaching note: 'Advice' is uncountable — a classic Hong Kong learner error because 'advise' (verb) and 'advice' (noun) are separate words, and students often treat 'advice' as plural. This is a different N error from Lesson 4.

PART 6: THEIR OWN PARAGRAPH (10 MINUTES)

Hunt (5 min): apply the four codes to the paragraph written before any teaching. Circle, do not fix.

Fix (5 min): second colour, at most ten words, no restructuring. Peer-check in pairs.

Read the room: students who find nothing need the plant done a second time, not a different lesson.

The tally strip replaces the old 'error card' — no copying of wrong sentences. Just counts at the bottom of the script they already wrote. The script IS the record.

PART 7: TRANSFER WRITE (3 MINUTES)

'His advice for stressed students', about 40 words. A new paragraph forces production, not just polishing.

PART 8: PEER PROOFREAD (4 MINUTES)

Swap paragraphs. Partner applies the four codes, circles errors, writes codes at the bottom, and signs.

PART 9: WHAT TO WATCH

- Do not mark the cold write. Not a tick. The moment it is marked, students stop hunting.
- Do not teach before the write. Any teaching that comes first contaminates the baseline.
- The planted-text score is a gauge, not a mark — and so is the own-text count.
- Keep the plant at 8 errors and the same length (≈ 100 words) every lesson.
- The proofreading window shrinks across the three lessons (5, then 4, then 3 minutes).
- Over-correction is the signal to name out loud: 'You changed three correct sentences.'
- Never read out one student's count. Class totals only, or seat numbers.

PART 10: CARRY-OVER TO LESSON 3

Target: sentence variety — combining short sentences correctly.

Plant: same length, 8 errors, 2 S / 2 V / 2 W / 2 N.

Write: a conclusion paragraph (≈ 40 words) — where writers rush and compress.